

XpressPro FX — Complete Deployment Guide

Running Outside Replit on a VPS Server

IMPORTANT: What Type of Hosting You Need

Your app is a full Node.js monorepo with:

- Express.js API backend
- React/Vite frontends (2 apps)
- PostgreSQL database
- WebSockets / live chat

This CANNOT run on standard GoDaddy shared hosting or cPanel. You need a VPS (Virtual Private Server) with root access.

Recommended VPS Options (Cheap & Reliable):

Provider	Plan	Monthly Cost
DigitalOcean	Basic Droplet 2GB	\$12/month
Vultr	Cloud Compute 2GB	\$12/month
Hetzner	CX22	\$6/month
Contabo	VPS S	\$6/month

OPTION A — Keep on Replit + Point Domain (EASIEST)

This is the recommended path. Your app already works on Replit. Just point your GoDaddy domain to Replit.

Step 1 — In Replit Publishing:

1. Open your project
2. Click the globe icon (Publishing)
3. Scroll down to Custom Domain
4. Add: xpressprofx.com
5. Add: admin.xpressprofx.com
6. Replit will show you DNS values to copy

Step 2 — In GoDaddy DNS:

Add these records:

Type	Name	Value	TTL
CNAME	www	code-fixer-2-zip.replit.app	600
CNAME	admin	code-fixer-2-zip.replit.app	600
A	@	34.111.179.208	600

OPTION B — Deploy to a VPS Server (FULL CONTROL)

STEP 1 — Get a VPS

Buy a VPS from DigitalOcean, Vultr, or Hetzner. Choose Ubuntu 22.04 as the operating system. Get at least 2GB RAM.

STEP 2 — Connect to Your VPS

On your computer open Terminal (Mac/Linux) or use PuTTY (Windows):

```
ssh root@YOUR_VPS_IP_ADDRESS
```

STEP 3 — Install Required Software

Run these commands on your VPS one by one:

```
# Update the server
apt update && apt upgrade -y

# Install Node.js 20
curl -fsSL https://deb.nodesource.com/setup_20.x | bash -
apt install -y nodejs

# Install pnpm (required - your project uses pnpm not npm)
npm install -g pnpm

# Install PostgreSQL database
apt install -y postgresql postgresql-contrib

# Install nginx (web server)
apt install -y nginx

# Install PM2 (keeps your app running)
npm install -g pm2

# Install git
apt install -y git
```

STEP 4 — Set Up PostgreSQL Database

```
# Start PostgreSQL
systemctl start postgresql
systemctl enable postgresql

# Create database and user
sudo -u postgres psql -c "CREATE USER xpresspro WITH PASSWORD 'YourStrongPassword'
sudo -u postgres psql -c "CREATE DATABASE xpressprofxdb OWNER xpresspro;"
sudo -u postgres psql -c "GRANT ALL PRIVILEGES ON DATABASE xpressprofxdb TO xpresspro"
```

STEP 5 — Upload Your Project Files

On your LOCAL computer (not VPS), install FileZilla or use scp:

```
# From your computer, zip and upload the project
scp -r /path/to/your/project root@YOUR_VPS_IP:/var/www/xpressprofx
```

Or use FileZilla:

1. Download FileZilla from filezilla-project.org
2. Connect to your VPS IP with your root credentials
3. Upload all your project files to `/var/www/xpressprofx`

Your folder structure on the VPS should look like:

```
/var/www/xpressprofx/  
  artifacts/  
    api-server/  
    nextrade/  
    admin-portal/  
  lib/  
  scripts/  
  package.json  
  pnpm-workspace.yaml
```

STEP 6 — Create Environment Variables File

On your VPS create the `.env` file:

```
nano /var/www/xpressprofx/.env
```

Paste this content (replace values with your real ones):

```
SESSION_SECRET="03/s620KqdDs7vXcMTLobR4CuD+tiJoWAvYAzgofpLCQqqdIRlY7bPYkCOw1wmngy  
ADMIN_PASSWORD="$GODisGOOD001"  
ADMIN_EMAIL="enwukwerigodspower7@gmail.com"  
SENDGRID_API_KEY="your-sendgrid-key-here"  
ALCHEMY_API_KEY="cndG1-d66YxbSN1FCzCDU"  
ADMIN_NOTIFY_EMAIL="enwukwerigodspower7@gmail.com"  
DATABASE_URL="postgresql://xpresspro:YourStrongPassword123@localhost/xpressprofxd  
NODE_ENV="production"  
PORT=8080
```

Save with `Ctrl+X` then `Y` then `Enter`.

STEP 7 — Fix Vite Config for Production

The `vite.config.ts` requires `PORT` and `BASE_PATH` env vars. Create a build script:

```
nano /var/www/xpressprofx/build.sh
```

Paste this:

```
#!/bin/bash
set -e

export NODE_ENV=production

# Load env vars
set -a
source /var/www/xpressprofx/.env
set +a

cd /var/www/xpressprofx

# Install all dependencies
pnpm install --frozen-lockfile

# Build shared libraries first
cd lib/db && pnpm run build 2>/dev/null || true
cd /var/www/xpressprofx
cd lib/api-zod && pnpm run build 2>/dev/null || true
cd /var/www/xpressprofx
cd lib/api-client-react && pnpm run build 2>/dev/null || true
cd /var/www/xpressprofx

# Build API server
cd artifacts/api-server && pnpm run build
cd /var/www/xpressprofx

# Build NeXTrade frontend
export PORT=3000
export BASE_PATH=/
cd artifacts/nextrade && pnpm run build
cd /var/www/xpressprofx

# Build Admin Portal
export PORT=3001
export BASE_PATH=/xadmin/
cd artifacts/admin-portal && pnpm run build
cd /var/www/xpressprofx

echo "BUILD COMPLETE"
```

Make it executable:

```
chmod +x /var/www/xpressprof/xpressprof/build.sh
```

Run it:

```
cd /var/www/xpressprof && bash build.sh
```

STEP 8 — Run Database Migrations

```
cd /var/www/xpressprof
source .env
cd lib/db && npx drizzle-kit push
```

STEP 9 — Start the API Server with PM2

```
# Create PM2 config
nano /var/www/xpressprof/ecosystem.config.cjs
```

Paste this:

```
module.exports = {
  apps: [
    {
      name: "xpressprof-api",
      script: "./artifacts/api-server/dist/index.mjs",
      cwd: "/var/www/xpressprof",
      env_file: "/var/www/xpressprof/.env",
      env: {
        NODE_ENV: "production",
        PORT: 8080
      },
      instances: 1,
      autorestart: true,
      watch: false,
      max_memory_restart: "500M"
    }
  ]
};
```

Start with PM2:

```
cd /var/www/xpressprofex
pm2 start ecosystem.config.cjs
pm2 save
pm2 startup
```

STEP 10 — Configure Nginx

```
nano /etc/nginx/sites-available/xpressprofex
```

Paste this entire config:

```
# Main website - xpressprofex.com
server {
    listen 80;
    server_name xpressprofex.com www.xpressprofex.com;

    # Serve NeXTrade frontend
    root /var/www/xpressprofex/artifacts/nextrade/dist;
    index index.html;

    # API proxy
    location /api/ {
        proxy_pass http://localhost:8080/;
        proxy_http_version 1.1;
        proxy_set_header Upgrade $http_upgrade;
        proxy_set_header Connection 'upgrade';
        proxy_set_header Host $host;
        proxy_set_header X-Real-IP $remote_addr;
        proxy_cache_bypass $http_upgrade;
    }

    # Frontend routes
    location / {
        try_files $uri $uri/ /index.html;
    }
}

# Admin portal - admin.xpressprofex.com
server {
    listen 80;
    server_name admin.xpressprofex.com;
```

```
root /var/www/xpressprofx/artifacts/admin-portal/dist;
index index.html;

location /api/ {
    proxy_pass http://localhost:8080/;
    proxy_http_version 1.1;
    proxy_set_header Host $host;
    proxy_set_header X-Real-IP $remote_addr;
}

location / {
    try_files $uri $uri/ /index.html;
}
}
```

Enable the config:

```
ln -s /etc/nginx/sites-available/xpressprofx /etc/nginx/sites-enabled/
nginx -t
systemctl restart nginx
```

STEP 11 — Add Free SSL Certificate (HTTPS)

```
apt install -y certbot python3-certbot-nginx
certbot --nginx -d xpressprofx.com -d www.xpressprofx.com -d admin.xpressprofx.co
```

Follow the prompts and enter your email address. SSL is now active and auto-renews.

STEP 12 — Point GoDaddy DNS to Your VPS

In GoDaddy DNS Manager add:

Type	Name	Value	TTL
A	@	YOUR_VPS_IP_ADDRESS	600
A	www	YOUR_VPS_IP_ADDRESS	600
A	admin	YOUR_VPS_IP_ADDRESS	600

AFTER DEPLOYMENT — Check Everything Works

```
# Check API is running
pm2 status

# Check API responds
curl http://localhost:8080/healthz

# Check nginx is running
systemctl status nginx

# View API logs
pm2 logs xpressprofx-api
```

IMPORTANT SECURITY REMINDERS

1. Regenerate your SendGrid API key — the old one was exposed
 2. Regenerate your Alchemy API key — the old one was exposed
 3. Change your admin password after first login
 4. Never share your .env file with anyone
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SUMMARY — Which Option To Choose

Your Situation	Best Option
GoDaddy shared hosting only	Stay on Replit, point domain via DNS
GoDaddy VPS/Dedicated server	Use Option B above
Want easiest solution	Stay on Replit (Option A)
Want full control	Get DigitalOcean VPS (Option B)

Need Help?

If you get stuck on any step, the error message will tell you exactly what went wrong.

Common fixes:

- "Permission denied" → add sudo before the command
- "Port already in use" → run: `pm2 delete all && pm2 start ecosystem.config.cjs`
- "Database connection failed" → check DATABASE_URL in .env matches your PostgreSQL setup